

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Defensive Operations (DefOps) | Incident Response, Threat Hunting, Security Tooling

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Analyst and Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience in Defensive Operations (DefOps), protecting organisations from cyber vulnerabilities and attacks through the technical configuration, maintenance and operation of security tooling. I play a key role in delivering security processes and tooling that enable the proportionate and effective application of security controls, working within growing security teams to define new ways of working using modern security architectures and tools. My expertise spans Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), threat hunting, incident response, and vulnerability management. I am experienced in mapping attacker Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs) to the MITRE ATT&CK Framework and operating in line with NIST 800-61 incident response methodology. I am committed to building a personal development pathway in security and am passionate about advancing the effectiveness of defensive operations through automation, detection engineering and continuous improvement.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Defensive Operations and Security Tooling:** CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, SOAR (Security Orchestration, Automation and Response), alert triage, detection rule development
- **Threat Hunting and Incident Response:** Proactive threat hunting, MITRE ATT&CK TTPs (Tactics, Techniques and Procedures) mapping, NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle, digital forensics triage, post-incident reporting
- **Detection Engineering:** KQL (Kusto Query Language) query development, custom detection rules, SOAR playbook automation, use case development
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera BAS (Breach and Attack Simulation), Nessus, AppCheck; risk-based remediation prioritisation
- **Endpoint and Identity Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for M365, Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (AD), BeyondTrust PAM (Privileged Access Management)
- **Modern Security Architectures:** Zero Trust, Cloud Security (Azure), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Email and Network Security:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony Firewall, WAF (Web Application Firewall), IDS (Intrusion Detection System) / IPS (Intrusion Prevention System)
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Scripting:** PowerShell, SOAR automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Responsible for the technical configuration, maintenance and operation of security tooling, including CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, to protect the organisation from cyber vulnerabilities and attacks
- Contributed to effective delivery of security processes and tooling, enabling proportionate and effective application of security controls across an 8,000-user estate
- Performed proactive threat hunting using KQL queries in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, identifying latent threats and reducing attacker dwell time

- Led incident response investigations in line with NIST 800-61, mapping attacker activity to MITRE ATT&CK TTPs and coordinating containment, eradication and recovery
- Developed and tuned detection rules and SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, improving the quality and speed of defensive operations
- Administered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI) and Defender for M365, contributing to a modern, layered defensive security architecture
- Led the vulnerability management programme using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io, Nessus and AppCheck, prioritising and remediating risks across the estate
- Worked closely with infrastructure, identity and network teams to define new ways of applying security controls using modern security architectures and tooling

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Performed SIEM alert triage and investigation across CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel, identifying and escalating threats and contributing to the continuous improvement of detection capabilities
- Conducted threat hunting activities using KQL queries, investigating anomalous behaviour and mapping findings to MITRE ATT&CK TTPs
- Supported incident response investigations, applying the NIST 800-61 lifecycle and contributing to post-incident reviews and lessons-learned sessions
- Managed vulnerability scanning and remediation using Tenable.io and Nessus, working with infrastructure teams to close identified risks
- Administered Entra ID, Azure Active Directory, MFA, SSO and BeyondTrust PAM to enforce identity security controls proportionate to risk
- Maintained security tooling including Mimecast email gateway and Check Point Harmony Firewall, applying configuration changes in line with security policies
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus certification and maintained compliance with ISO 27001 and NIST CSF controls

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Managed security tooling and infrastructure in a SaaS/FinTech environment, supporting endpoint protection, access management and vulnerability assessments
- Supported security monitoring, incident triage and firewall management, contributing to a secure and compliant operating environment

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Configured and maintained CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across 8,000 users, achieving comprehensive endpoint visibility and measurably improving the organisation's defensive operations maturity
- Built and tuned Microsoft Sentinel detection rules and SOAR playbooks, improving alert quality and enabling faster, more consistent incident response
- Led multiple high-severity incident response investigations at UAL, applying NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK mapping to contain threats and minimise business impact
- Delivered Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL, demonstrating the proportionate application of security controls to protect against common cyber threats
- Implemented Pentera BAS to continuously validate defensive controls, enabling risk-based prioritisation of remediation activities
- Automated SOAR response playbooks for common threat scenarios, reducing analyst workload and enabling the defensive operations team to scale effectively

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)

- CompTIA Security Plus (Security+)
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A Plus (A+)
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)